

RentaPay

A guide for landlords, property managers & caretakers, and tenants

Generated 27 August 2026

Understand RentaPay

The problem

Collecting rent across even a handful of units usually means chasing bank slips, cross checking M Pesa messages against a spreadsheet, and hoping nothing falls through the cracks when a caretaker forgets to note a cash payment. Multiply that across several properties, a property manager, and a caretaker on the ground, and reconciliation becomes a part time job on its own. Security deposits get tracked in a notebook, or not at all. Utility bills for a shared water meter get split by guesswork. A tenant who paid reliably for two years at one building has no way to show that history to a new landlord across town.

What RentaPay does

RentaPay is a single system that landlords, property managers, caretakers, general managers, and tenants all use to keep rent collection, records, deposits, utility billing, maintenance, and reporting in one place.

- **Landlords** see every property, every unit, and every payment, paid, pending, or late, without waiting on anyone to compile a report, and can record a security deposit, bill a shared utility meter, and generate an annual report from the same dashboard.
- **Property managers and caretakers** record payments as they happen, including manual and cash payments, submit meter readings, and handle maintenance and tenant contact, all scoped to only the properties they have been given access to.
- **General managers** run the operational side of a landlord's business day to day, with sensitive actions protected by their own Operations PIN and reviewable by the landlord afterward.
- **Tenants** get a clear way to pay, submit their payment code, see their deposit status and any utility bill, raise a maintenance request or dispute, and build a rating history that can travel with them to a new landlord.

Who it is for

Whether you manage one unit or a hundred, across one building or several, RentaPay scales with you. You can add properties, units, and staff as your portfolio grows, without changing how the system works.

Trust, in short

RentaPay never mixes up whose money is whose. Every payment is tied to a specific tenant, unit, and property, and only the people you have explicitly given access to, a manager, caretaker, or general manager you have invited, can see or act on your properties. Rent itself is paid directly from tenant to landlord by M Pesa. RentaPay never holds, takes custody of, or has control over that money at any point. See the Privacy Policy for full detail on how your data is handled, and the Terms of Service for exactly what RentaPay is and is not.

A quick tour of this guide

This guide walks through RentaPay in the order most people actually need it: pricing and how a subscription is paid, exactly how a rent payment moves from tenant to landlord, then a full tour of the landlord, manager, and tenant portals, followed by dedicated sections on security deposits, utility submetering, tenant ratings, disputes and the community board, general managers and Brand Ambassadors, security and privacy, notifications, reporting and data export, payment plans and vacating notices, getting started, troubleshooting, how to reach support, a short FAQ, and a glossary of terms used throughout. You do not need to read it start to finish. Each section stands on its own, so feel free to jump straight to whichever part answers the question you actually came here with.

How pricing works

RentaPay works on a **subscription**, not a commission taken from each rent payment. When a landlord signs up, they subscribe **per unit, per month**. The price per unit is set by RentaPay and may change over time, and the current rate is always shown within the app before a landlord confirms a purchase.

How subscribing works

- At sign up, a landlord chooses how many units to subscribe and for how long, for example twenty two units for two months.
- The subscription covers those units for that period. Collecting and confirming rent through RentaPay during that window does not cost anything extra per payment, no matter how many payments come through.
- When a subscription is close to expiring, the landlord is notified within the app and by email, so renewal is never a surprise.
- If a subscription lapses without renewal, access to certain landlord side features, such as onboarding a new tenant or receiving the optional portfolio digest email, may be reduced until it is renewed. Every record already saved, tenants, payment history, deposits, and everything else, stays exactly where it was and is not deleted for a lapsed subscription alone.

How a subscription is actually paid

A landlord has two ways to pay a subscription:

- **Automatic, through M Pesa STK push.** RentaPay itself triggers a prompt on the landlord's phone through Safaricom's Daraja API. The landlord enters their M Pesa PIN once, and the payment is confirmed automatically the moment Safaricom reports it back to RentaPay, with no manual review step needed on either side.
- **Manual, by sending payment directly.** A landlord can instead send payment to RentaPay's own Paybill or Till number outside the app, and then submit proof of that payment within RentaPay, the same way a tenant submits proof of a rent payment. This starts as a pending submission and is reviewed and confirmed by a RentaPay administrator, which typically takes a little longer than the automatic option since it involves a human check.

Loyalty discounts

RentaPay may from time to time grant a landlord a discount on their subscription in recognition of a long standing, continuously active account. Where a discount is granted, it is shown within the app along with its size and its expiry date, and an unused discount that is not applied before that date can lapse.

What is included

- Unlimited tenant accounts for your subscribed units
- Manager, caretaker, and general manager accounts with permission controls
- Security deposit tracking, kept separate from the rent ledger
- Utility submetering for shared or individual water and electricity billing
- Payment records, receipts, and portfolio reporting, including an annual report and a data export
- Tenant ratings, portable reputation, disputes, and the community board
- Support through the in app chat, plus phone, WhatsApp, and email

Current subscription rates are confirmed at sign up, since they can move with the market. Reach out through the contact details on this page if you would like current pricing before you sign up.

How payments flow

There are two separate kinds of payment inside RentaPay, and they work differently on purpose. Understanding the difference matters.

Rent, from tenant to landlord

Rent is always confirmed manually, by design, because RentaPay never touches this money at any point.

1. **The tenant pays** rent using M Pesa, whether through the landlord's Paybill, Till number, or personal phone number shown in their portal, exactly as they would pay it outside the app. Safaricom processes this as an ordinary transfer directly between tenant and landlord.
2. **The tenant submits proof** in RentaPay: the M Pesa transaction code, the amount, the payer name and phone number, and the time shown on the M Pesa confirmation message.
3. **The landlord, manager, or caretaker reviews** the submission against their own M Pesa records and either confirms it as received or rejects it, for example if the amount does not match.
4. **Once confirmed**, everything updates automatically: the tenant's balance, the landlord's dashboard, and a receipt the tenant can view or download.

This review step exists deliberately, for trust: since RentaPay never holds or moves the tenant's money itself, only the person who actually received the funds can confirm they arrived. It is not a placeholder for something more automatic coming later; it is how rent collection is meant to work on RentaPay, because RentaPay is a record keeping tool, not a payment processor for rent itself.

Manual and cash payments

Some tenants pay by cash or bank deposit instead of M Pesa. A property manager or caretaker can record that payment directly on the tenant's behalf, and it goes through the same review step before it is confirmed.

Subscriptions, from landlord to RentaPay

A landlord's own subscription payment to RentaPay works differently, and can be fully automatic. See the Pricing section for the two ways a landlord can pay a subscription: an automatic M Pesa STK push that confirms itself the moment Safaricom reports it, or a manual payment reviewed by a RentaPay administrator.

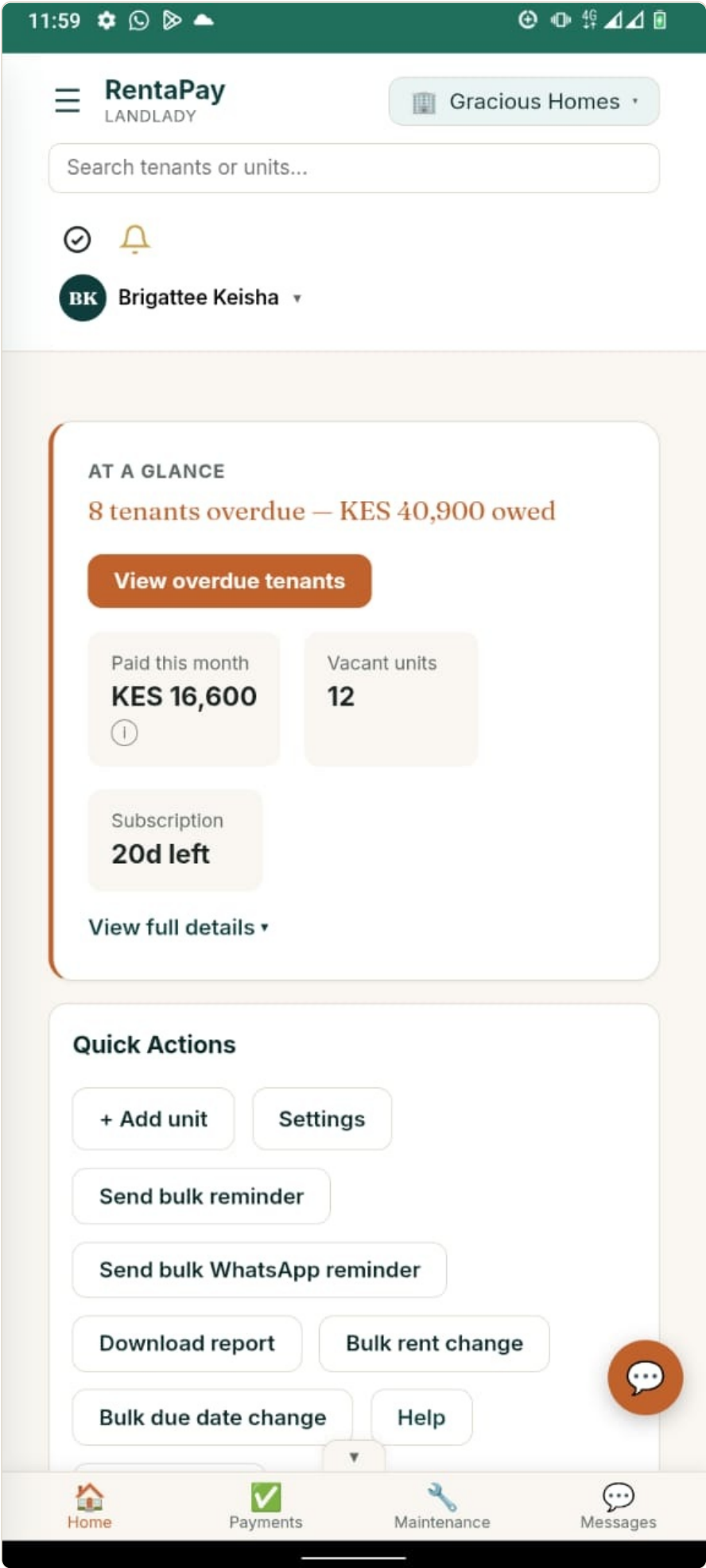
Utility bills

Where a landlord has set up utility submetering, a finalised water or electricity bill becomes its own invoice, separate from rent. Depending on how the landlord has configured it, a tenant may pay a utility bill the same way they pay rent, with proof submitted and reviewed the same way.

Receipts

Once a rent payment is confirmed, it generates a receipt the tenant can view or download at any time, and the landlord can always see exactly who submitted a payment and who reviewed and confirmed it.

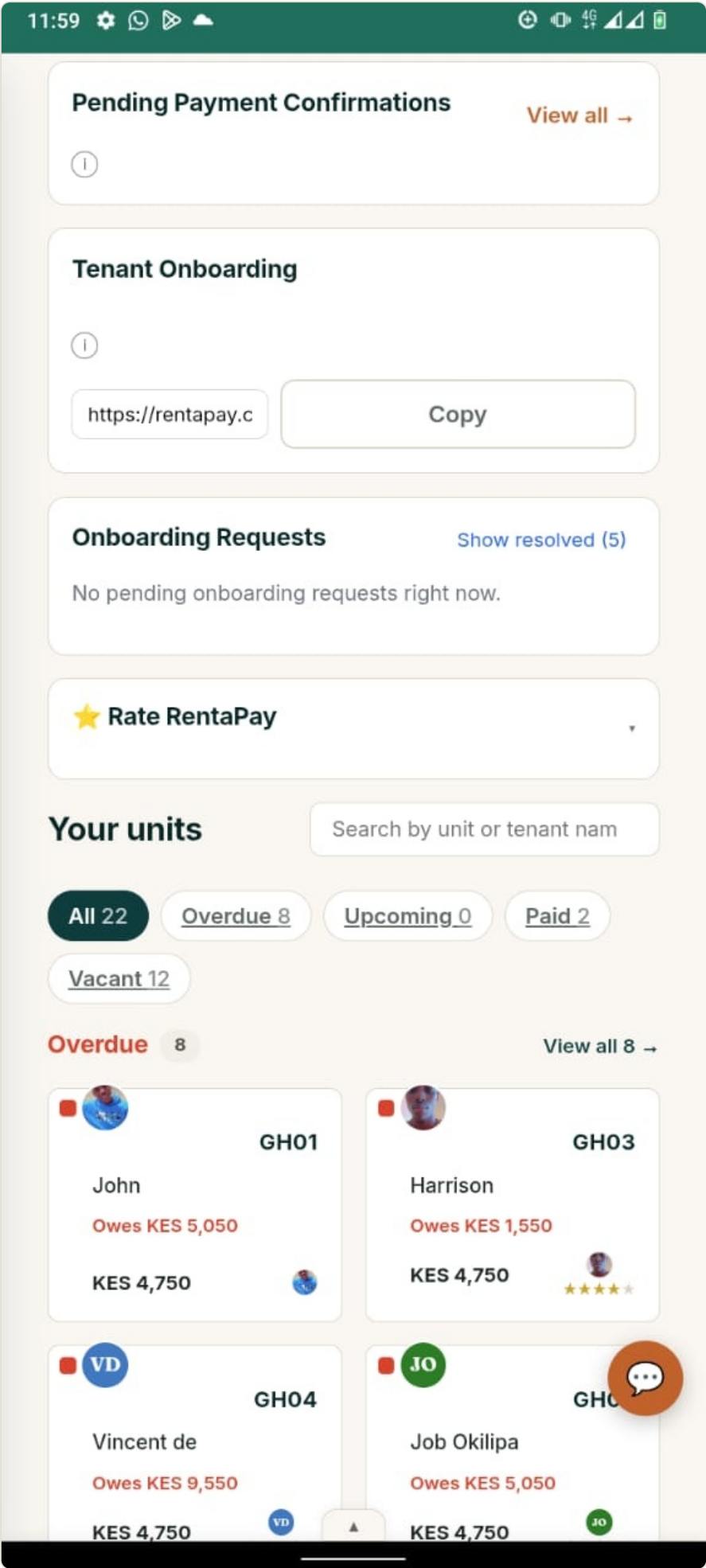
The Landlord portal



Real product screenshot. Landlord and tenant names, and amounts shown, are illustrative.

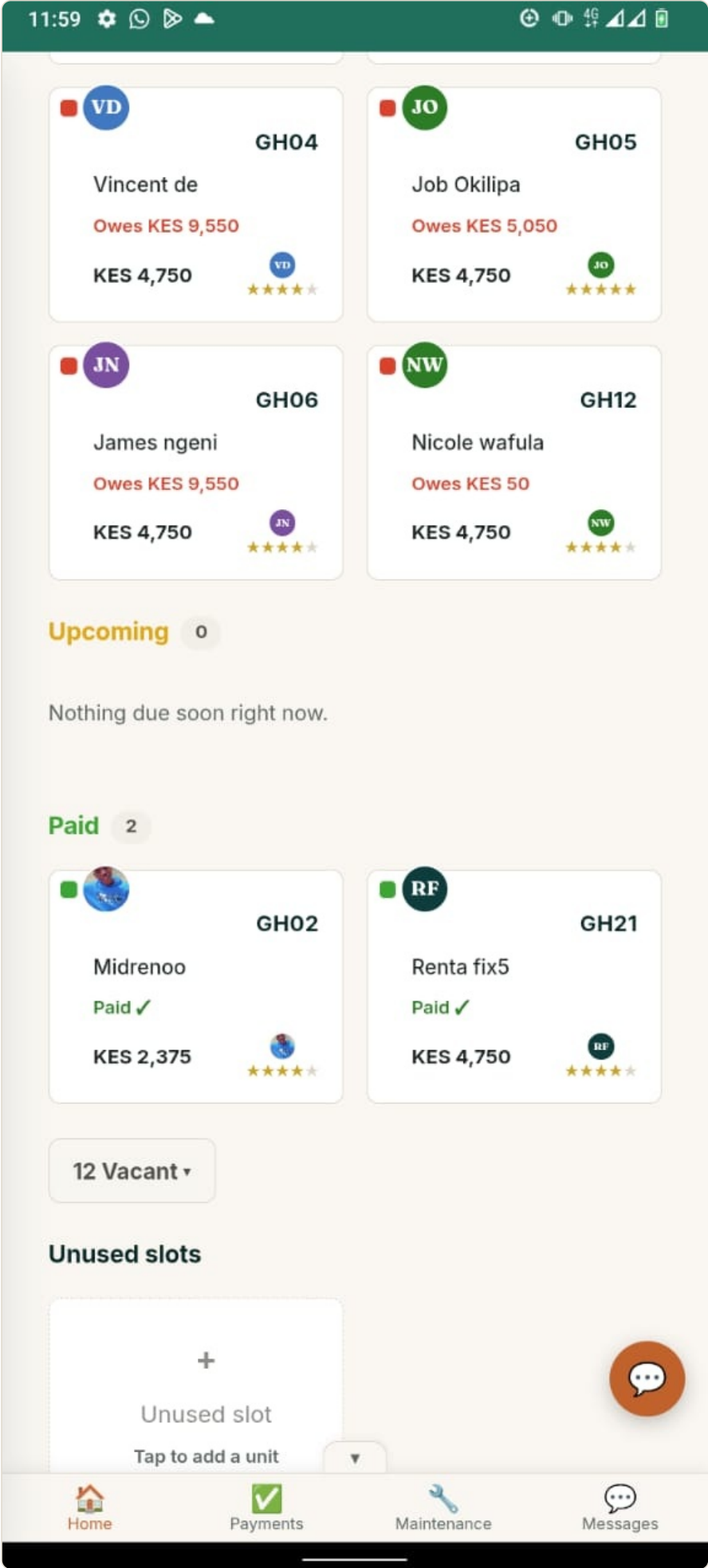
From the landlord dashboard you can see, at a glance:

- **Tenants overdue and the total owed**, front and center, with a one tap way to view them.
- **What has been paid this month**, how many units are vacant, and how many days are left on your subscription.
- **Quick actions**: add a unit, send a bulk rent or WhatsApp reminder, download a report, or change rent and due dates across units at once.



illustrative. Real product screenshot. Tenant names and amounts shown are

Below the summary, every unit shows its tenant, what they owe, and their status, filterable to All, Overdue, Upcoming, Paid, or Vacant, so you can go straight to the tenants who need attention.



Real product screenshot. Tenant names and amounts shown are illustrative.

Paid tenants are shown just as clearly as overdue ones, along with a count of vacant units and any unused slots on your subscription, ready to assign

to a new tenant.

10:28

4G

Photos

Photos







Add photos (up to 2 more)

Choose Files

No file chosen

[Use these photos on other units too](#)

Listing status

Occupied

☐

This unit requires a deposit from a future tenant

☒

List this unit on the public listings page when vacant

Rent & due date

Monthly rent

KES 4,750

[Change](#)

Due day of month

Day 1

[Change](#)

Payment method

Using the general default payment method

[Set override](#)

Extra charges

Real product screenshot.

Each unit has its own settings: photos, whether it is occupied or listed publicly when vacant, monthly rent and due date, security deposit requirements, and payment method, so unit level details stay accurate as tenants move in and out. A unit's photos scroll through the same smooth, focus based photo strip used throughout the app, whether you are viewing them here or a visitor is viewing them on the public listing page.

**RentaPay****Dashboard**

OVERVIEW ▶

FINANCES ▶

TENANTS ▶

OPERATIONS ▶

ACCOUNT ▼



Settings



Manage subscription



First-Time Login Details



FAQs



Help / Complaints



Virtual Assistant



Gracious Homes ▾

\$ 40,900 owed

t units

nder

k rent change

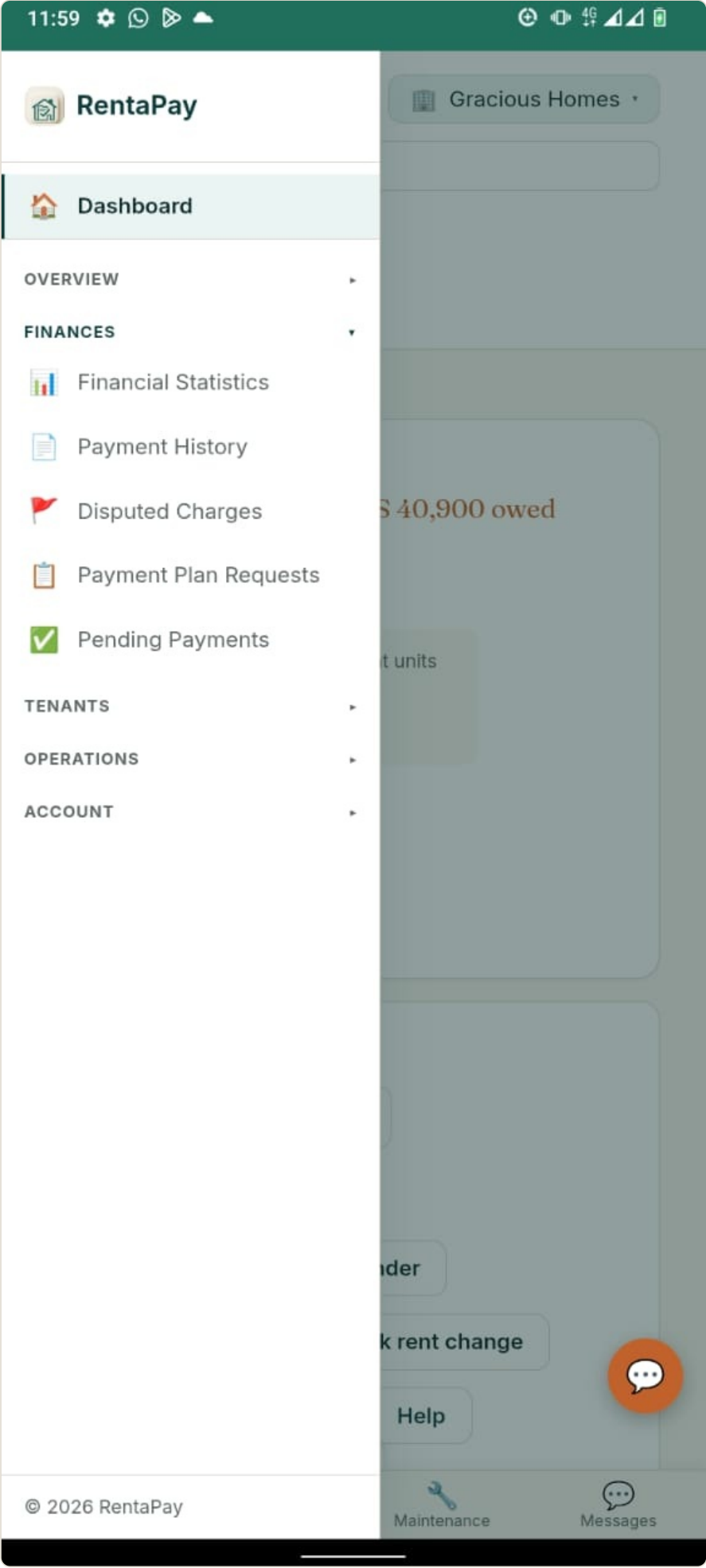
Help



Maintenance



Messages



Real product screenshots.

The full menu gives you everything in one place: overview, finances (statistics, payment history, disputed charges, payment plan requests, pending confirmations), tenants, day to day operations, and account settings including subscription management, an annual report, and a data export of your own records.

You can add properties and units as your portfolio grows, and invite a property manager, caretaker, or general manager to a specific property without

giving them access to your other properties.

Property managers, caretakers, and general managers

Everyone you invite logs into the same landlord portal shown above. There is no separate app or layout for them. What changes is what they are allowed to see and do, scoped to the property or properties you have given them access to.

Property managers can do almost everything a landlord can on their assigned properties: record and review payments, manage tenants, and handle day to day operations.

General managers sit above property managers in trust and scope, typically running the operational side of your business across some or all of your properties. A general manager protects sensitive actions behind their own personal Operations PIN, separate from their login password, which they are asked for again before completing certain high impact actions. You can review a general manager's activity through an activity log, and, for a defined set of actions, revert what they have done within a limited window afterward.

Caretakers have a lighter weight version of the same portal, meant for someone on the ground rather than someone handling the books. A caretaker can view their assigned properties and tenants, send reminders, submit utility meter readings, and revoke a vacating notice, but cannot:

- Record, confirm, or reject a rent payment
- View payment history, financial statistics, or disputed charges
- Access payment plan requests
- Add, remove, or edit units, or change rent amounts
- Add extra charges, upload documents, or log expenses
- Remove a tenant, edit a tenant's balance, settle a security deposit, or transfer a tenant between units
- View the list of other property managers
- Edit payment method details

If a caretaker tries to do any of these, they are shown a message pointing them to the landlord or property manager instead.

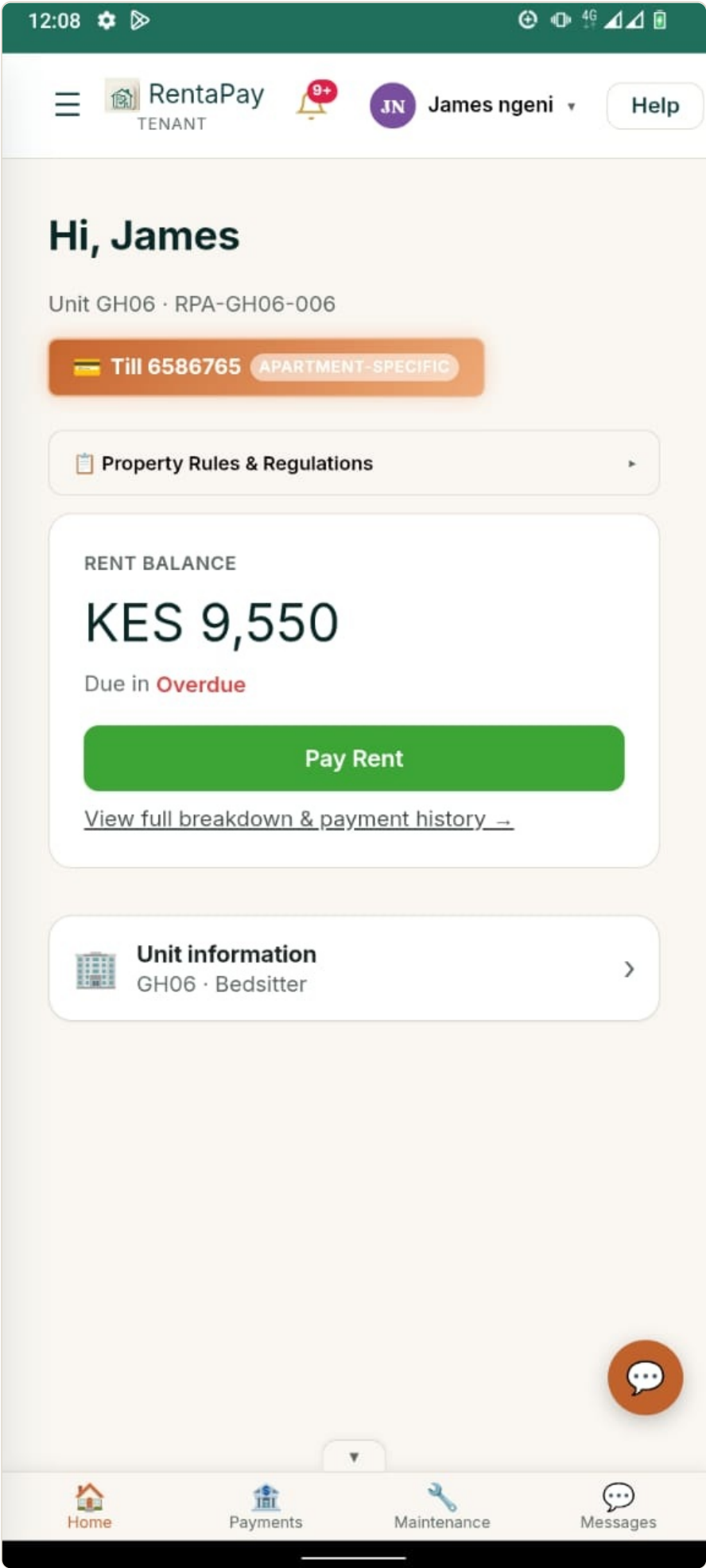
Security deposits, at a glance

When you onboard a tenant, you can record whether they paid a security deposit, and how much. That amount is tracked completely separately from rent; it is never added to a tenant's balance and never drawn against automatically. When a tenancy ends, you record what happened to the deposit: refunded in full, partially refunded with a reason for anything withheld, or forfeited. See the dedicated Security Deposits section of this guide for the full picture.

Utility submetering, at a glance

Where a property has a shared or individual water or electricity meter, you can set it up, submit monthly readings, and let RentaPay calculate each unit's share of the bill based on occupied days, with the ability to review and override before finalising and sending it. See the dedicated Utility Submetering section of this guide for the full picture.

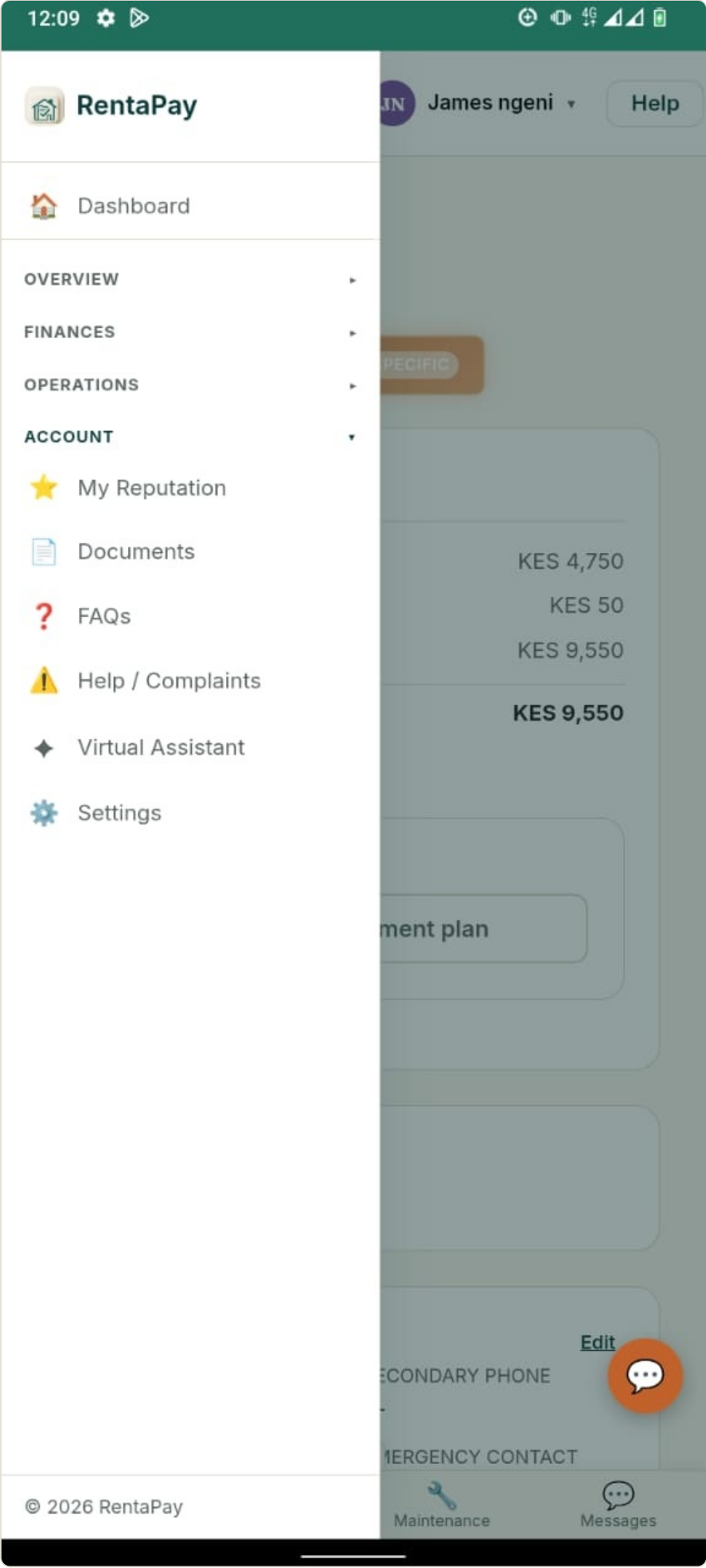
The Tenant portal



Real product screenshot. Tenant name and balance shown are illustrative.

Tenants use RentaPay to:

- **See exactly what is due**, including whether it is upcoming or overdue, and the till or account number to pay to.
- **Pay and submit their payment code**. After paying to the number shown, the tenant enters the confirmation code in the app, which the landlord or their manager or caretaker then reviews and approves.
- **View their full payment breakdown and history**, and access a receipt once a payment is approved.
- **See their security deposit status**, once their landlord or manager has recorded it: the amount paid at move in, and, once a tenancy ends, whether it was refunded, partially refunded, or forfeited.
- **View a utility bill**, where the landlord has set up water or electricity submetering, showing usage and cost for their unit.
- **Raise a maintenance request or complaint**, and dispute a payment record they believe is wrong, all tracked in one place with the landlord's or manager's response visible alongside it.
- **Build a portable reputation**. A tenant's aggregate rating, based on payment reliability and care of the unit as scored by every landlord who has managed them, is tied to their own email address so it can, at their own choice, follow them to a new landlord on RentaPay, or be shared through a link they generate themselves.
- **Post to the community board**, where their landlord has enabled it, to reach other tenants at the same property.
- **Reach support**: call, WhatsApp, in app chat, or email, directly from the portal if something is not right. These contact details are kept current by the landlord's team, so tenants always have a working way to get help.



Real product screenshot.

Tenants also have access to their reputation history, documents shared with them, FAQs, and a way to raise a complaint or reach the built in virtual assistant directly from their own menu. The virtual assistant walks a tenant through the portal the first time they log in, and stays available afterward through its own floating button.

Security deposits

Many landlords collect a security deposit at the start of a tenancy, refundable later depending on the condition the unit is left in. RentaPay gives you a clean, dedicated way to record this, kept entirely separate from rent.

Recording a deposit

When you onboard a new tenant, or at any point afterward from that tenant's unit screen, you can record whether they paid a security deposit and how much. This figure is stored on its own; it is never added to the tenant's rent balance, is never available to be drawn down against unpaid rent automatically, and is never treated by RentaPay as money the platform itself holds. A tenant can see their own recorded deposit amount and its current status at any time from their own portal.

Settling a deposit at move out

When a tenancy ends, you or your manager settles the deposit by recording one of three outcomes:

- **Refunded**, meaning the full amount was returned to the tenant.
- **Partially refunded**, meaning some amount was returned and some was withheld, together with a written reason for what was withheld and why.
- **Forfeited**, meaning none of the deposit was returned.

This is a record keeping feature, not a payment feature. RentaPay does not decide, verify, or adjudicate whether a deduction was fair or lawful, and does not itself transfer any money as part of this process. What counts as a lawful deduction from a security deposit is governed by the tenancy agreement between you and your tenant, and by applicable Kenyan law, not by anything RentaPay displays.

Why keep it separate from rent

Keeping a deposit as its own record, rather than folding it into a tenant's general balance, means a tenant can never be shown as owing money simply because a deposit has not been formally settled yet, and a landlord always has a clean, dated history of what was collected and what happened to it at the end of every tenancy across their whole portfolio.

Utility submetering

Where a property has a water or electricity meter that covers more than one unit, or an individual meter per unit, RentaPay can turn a monthly reading into a fair, itemised bill for each tenant, without you needing a separate spreadsheet.

Setting up a meter

A landlord, manager, or caretaker can register a meter against a property, marking it as either an individual meter serving one specific unit, or a shared meter serving several units at once. Each meter has its own billing rate, set by the landlord, used to convert usage into a cost.

Submitting a reading

Each billing period, whoever is responsible, often a caretaker on site, submits the current meter reading. RentaPay compares it to the meter's previous reading to work out total usage for the period, and flags a reading that looks unusually high or low compared to that meter's own history, so an obvious typing mistake gets caught before a bill goes out.

Splitting a shared meter fairly

For a shared meter covering several units, RentaPay does not simply divide the total bill evenly. It looks at how many days each unit actually had an active tenant during that billing period, and splits the cost proportionally, so a unit that was vacant for part of the month is not charged as if it had been occupied the whole time.

Reviewing before you finalise

Before a bill goes out, a landlord or manager can review every unit's calculated occupied days and amount, and override either one where there is a genuine reason to, for example a tenant who moved in partway through the month in a way the system's own dates did not fully capture. Once you are satisfied, finalising the bill sends it to the affected tenant or tenants as its own invoice, separate from their rent balance.

Paying a utility bill

Depending on how you have configured the property, a tenant may pay their utility bill the same way they pay rent: through M Pesa, with the transaction code submitted in the app and reviewed and confirmed by the landlord, manager, or caretaker.

Tenant ratings and portable reputation

RentaPay lets a landlord, manager, or caretaker rate a tenant on things like payment reliability and how well they have cared for the unit, and lets a tenant rate their landlord, manager, or the property itself in return.

How a tenant's aggregate score works

Every time a landlord rates a tenant, that rating feeds into an aggregate score for that tenant, broken down by category and by the role of whoever rated them. This aggregate score is tied to the tenant's own registered email address rather than to any single landlord's account. That single design choice is what makes the score portable: a tenant who has built a strong payment history at one property can carry that same score with them if they move to a new landlord who also uses RentaPay, entirely at the tenant's own choice, since nothing about it happens automatically or without the tenant's involvement.

Sharing a reputation score

A tenant can generate a shareable link to their own aggregate reputation score, and choose to send that link to a prospective new landlord when inquiring about a vacant unit, whether that landlord uses RentaPay or not. What is shared through that link is only the aggregate score and its category breakdown, never any individual written comment.

Privacy of written comments

Where a rating includes an optional written comment, that comment is visible only to the tenant it is about, on their own account, and to RentaPay's own support and moderation team where relevant. It is never shown to any other landlord, including within a reputation summary a tenant shares themselves.

Flagging an unfair rating

A tenant who believes a rating is inaccurate, retaliatory, or abusive can flag it for review directly from their portal. RentaPay may, at its own discretion, remove or adjust a rating found to breach the Terms of Service.

Disputes, complaints, and the community board

Disputing a payment

If a tenant believes a payment record is wrong, for example a payment they submitted was rejected in error, or a confirmed amount does not match what they actually paid, they can raise a dispute directly from their portal. This creates a timestamped record both sides can see, and the landlord, manager, or caretaker responsible for that unit can respond within the same tool. RentaPay does not decide who is right in a dispute; it simply keeps a clear, shared record of what was raised and how it was answered, so nothing gets lost in a message thread.

Raising a complaint or maintenance request

Separately from a payment dispute, a tenant can raise a general complaint or a maintenance request, describing the issue and, where relevant, attaching a photo. The landlord, manager, or caretaker responsible sees it immediately and can update its status as it is worked on, so a tenant is never left wondering whether a request was actually received.

When something needs to go further

More serious matters, such as a dispute over a security deposit refund, an alleged unlawful eviction, or a habitability issue, are civil matters between landlord and tenant. RentaPay's tools are there to make communication easier and to keep a record, not to adjudicate; if something cannot be resolved between the two of you directly, it may need to go to Kenya's courts, rent tribunals, or another dispute resolution body outside the platform.

The community board

Where a landlord turns it on, tenants and landlord side users at a property can post to and reply on a shared community board, for example to share a notice, ask a question, or arrange something informally between neighbours. A post is visible only to other users of that same community, not to the wider public, and stays the responsibility of whoever posted it. RentaPay can remove a post that breaks the platform's acceptable use rules once it becomes aware of it, though posts are not reviewed before they go up.

General managers and Brand Ambassadors

General managers

A general manager is a more senior, trusted management role a landlord can choose to set up, intended for someone who effectively runs the day to day operational side of the landlord's business, potentially across several properties at once.

The first time a general manager needs to use a sensitive tool, they set their own four digit Operations PIN, separate entirely from the password they use to log in. That PIN is asked for again before certain higher impact actions can be completed, adding a deliberate, second confirmation step beyond simply being logged in. A general manager can change their own PIN at any time from settings, as long as they know the current one.

Because a general manager acts with a wide scope of trust, every sensitive action they take is recorded in an activity log the landlord can review at any time, and, for a defined set of actions, the landlord can revert what was done within a limited window afterward. This gives a landlord a genuine safety net without requiring them to approve every single action a trusted general manager takes.

Brand Ambassadors

A Brand Ambassador is an independent representative who introduces new landlords to RentaPay under a separate arrangement, earning a payout once an introduced landlord meets qualification criteria, such as remaining an active, paying subscriber for a defined period.

A Brand Ambassador has their own dashboard, entirely separate from a landlord's or manager's, showing only the landlords they themselves have introduced, along with each one's current qualification status and payout status. A Brand Ambassador cannot see any operational data belonging to a landlord they introduced beyond what is needed to confirm that landlord still qualifies, and cannot see any other Brand Ambassador's own introductions.

Qualification criteria and payout amounts are set by RentaPay and may be updated from time to time, with the current criteria always visible within a Brand Ambassador's own dashboard.

Security and privacy

RentaPay is built to keep each landlord's portfolio and each tenant's information visible only to the people who genuinely need to see it.

Role based access

Every account has a role, landlord, property manager, general manager, caretaker, tenant, or Brand Ambassador, and every screen and every piece of data in RentaPay checks that role before showing anything. A property manager only ever sees the properties a landlord has explicitly given them access to; a tenant only ever sees their own balance and history, never another tenant's, even within the same building.

Passwords and PINs

Your password, and a general manager's Operations PIN, are never stored as plain text. Each is passed through a one way cryptographic hash before it is saved, which means RentaPay itself cannot see or recover your actual password even if it wanted to. When you log in, what you type is hashed the same way and compared to the stored hash, rather than the original ever being stored anywhere.

Guarding against brute force attempts

Repeated failed login attempts against an account trigger a temporary logout, and requests to sensitive endpoints, such as the login and password reset flows, are rate limited, meaning only a limited number of attempts are allowed within a short window. This makes it far harder for someone to simply guess their way into an account.

Encrypted transport

Every request sent to and from RentaPay, whether you are logging in, submitting a payment, or just loading your dashboard, travels over an encrypted HTTPS connection, so it cannot be read in transit by anyone else on the same network.

What RentaPay relies on behind the scenes

RentaPay's own database and file storage, for records such as unit photos, payment proof screenshots, and documents, are provided by a specialist cloud infrastructure provider, accessed only through RentaPay's own backend, which enforces every one of the access rules described above itself, rather than leaving that enforcement to the infrastructure provider. Email, including one time verification codes and password reset codes, is sent through a specialist third party email delivery provider. Landlord subscription payments made by STK push go through Safaricom's own Daraja API. None of these providers are given more access to your information than the specific job RentaPay uses them for requires, and RentaPay does not sell your data to anyone or use it for advertising. See the Privacy Policy for the full, detailed picture of exactly what is collected, why, and for how long.

A public status page, always available

If you are ever unsure whether a problem you are seeing is on RentaPay's side, a public status page shows the live operational state of every major part of the platform, including the API, the database, sign in, payments, email delivery, push notifications, file storage, background jobs, support chat, and the public listings page, and is available without needing to log in at all.

Session handling

Once you log in, RentaPay issues a session that keeps you signed in without asking for your password on every single screen. That session is tied to your specific device and browser, and logging out, or simply not using RentaPay for an extended period, ends it. If you ever suspect someone else has accessed your account, change your password immediately and contact support so we can help review recent activity on it.

Keeping your own account safe

A few habits go a long way: use a password that is not reused from another service, never share your login details or, if you are a general manager, your Operations PIN, with anyone else, and log out of RentaPay on a shared or public device once you are done using it. If you manage staff accounts, remove access promptly once someone's role changes or their time working with you ends, since RentaPay itself has no way of knowing that has happened until you tell it.

Notifications and reminders

RentaPay keeps everyone in the loop automatically, so a landlord is not left manually messaging every tenant every month, and a tenant is never caught off guard by a due date they did not know was coming.

Email

Email carries account essentials: one time verification codes used to log in or reset a password, receipts once a payment is confirmed, rent due and overdue reminders, and, for a landlord who opts in, a periodic portfolio digest summarising occupancy, rent collected, and any vacant unit that is still missing photos. A landlord can turn the digest email on or off at any time from settings; the essential account emails, such as a one time verification code, cannot be turned off, since the feature they support could not otherwise work.

Push notifications

Where a landlord, manager, caretaker, or tenant enables it, RentaPay can send a live alert straight to a browser or device, even when the RentaPay tab is not open. This is used for time sensitive events: a new payment submission waiting to be reviewed, a maintenance request update, a new chat message, or a reminder that a subscription is about to expire. Push notifications are entirely optional and can be turned off at any time from device or browser settings.

Bulk reminders

A landlord or manager can send a rent reminder to every overdue tenant at once, rather than messaging each one individually, either as an in app notification or as a WhatsApp message using the tenant's own registered phone number. This is especially useful right around a due date, when several tenants may need the same nudge on the same day.

Reminders that run on their own schedule

Behind the scenes, RentaPay runs a set of scheduled jobs that keep the platform current without anyone needing to trigger them by hand: rent due and overdue reminders, monthly utility and rent billing, subscription expiry reminders, and processing of vacating notices once their notice period has passed. None of these require a landlord or tenant to do anything; they simply run on their own schedule in the background.

Reports, documents, and data export

Beyond day to day rent collection, RentaPay gives a landlord several ways to step back and see the bigger picture across their whole portfolio, or pull their own records out of the platform entirely.

Annual report

A landlord can generate an annual report for a chosen year, compiling rent collected, outstanding balances, and occupancy across every property into a single summary. This is useful for a landlord's own bookkeeping, or for sharing a clear picture of a year's performance with an accountant or business partner.

Financial statistics and payment history

The Finances section of the landlord portal shows financial statistics across a portfolio, a full payment history with every confirmed, rejected, and disputed payment, and a dedicated view of any payment plan a tenant has requested, so nothing about the money side of the business needs to be pieced together from memory.

Document storage

A landlord, manager, or caretaker can attach documents to a tenant or a property, such as a signed lease, so that important paperwork lives alongside the tenancy it belongs to rather than in a separate folder somewhere else entirely.

Expense tracking

A landlord can record costs associated with running a property, kept separate from tenant facing rent and deposit records, so that income and outgoings can both be seen from the same place when it is time to review how a property is actually performing.

Data export

A landlord can request an export of their own account's underlying records in a portable format at any time. Like every other feature in RentaPay, this export only ever contains data that landlord's own account was already entitled to see; it is simply a way to take that same data outside the app when needed.

Payment plans and giving notice to vacate

Payment plans

Sometimes a tenant cannot pay the full month at once, and needs to split it into a few smaller payments instead. A tenant can propose a payment plan directly from their portal: a total amount, split into at least two installments, each with its own amount and due date, and an optional reason. The installment amounts must add up exactly to the total being requested.

Once submitted, the landlord is notified with the full proposed schedule, and can approve or decline it from the Payment Plan Requests section of the Finances menu. A tenant can only have one payment plan request awaiting a decision at a time, so a landlord is never juggling several competing proposals from the same tenant at once.

Giving notice to vacate

When a tenant plans to move out, they can submit a vacating notice from their portal, giving their intended move out date. This immediately flips their unit's status to notice given and notifies the landlord, so the landlord knows a vacancy is coming well before it arrives.

As that date gets closer, RentaPay reminds the tenant automatically, three days before and again one day before, and each reminder tells the tenant to contact their landlord directly if the notice was submitted by mistake and they want to revoke it. On the notice date itself, the tenant's account is deactivated and the unit flips from notice given to vacant, ready to be listed or assigned to a new tenant. Deactivating the account does not erase anything: the tenant's payment history and their portable reputation record are preserved exactly the same way they are when a landlord removes a tenant directly, not deleted.

If a tenant changes their mind before the notice date arrives, reaching out to their landlord, manager, or caretaker to revoke the notice keeps the unit marked as occupied and cancels the countdown entirely.

Getting started

1. **Sign up** as a landlord with your basic contact details: full name, phone number, and email address.
2. **Add your properties and units**, as many as you have, whenever you have them. There is no limit and no extra step for adding more later. Each unit can have its own rent amount, due date, deposit requirement, and photos.
3. **Choose your subscription**, per unit and per month, and pay it either automatically by M Pesa STK push, confirmed the moment Safaricom reports it, or manually by sending payment to RentaPay's own Paybill or Till number and submitting proof for review.
4. **Invite your managers, caretakers, and, if you need one, a general manager**, scoped to the specific properties they should have access to. A general manager sets their own Operations PIN the first time they use a sensitive tool.
5. **Add your tenants**, either yourself or by having your manager or caretaker do it, or by turning on self onboarding so an invited tenant can complete their own details. Each tenant gets their own portal access, and you can record whether they paid a security deposit as part of onboarding.
6. **Set up utility submetering**, if your property has a shared or individual water or electricity meter you want to bill tenants for.
7. **Start collecting**. Tenants can pay by M Pesa and submit their code, or your team can record a manual or cash payment, from day one.

Most landlords are set up and seeing their first payments within the same day. There is no paperwork beyond your own account details and the properties you want to add.

Troubleshooting common issues

A tenant's payment submission was rejected. Check the transaction code, amount, and payer details against your own M Pesa statement. A common cause is a code that was typed with one wrong character, or an amount that does not match because the tenant included their own transaction charge in the figure. Ask the tenant to resubmit with the corrected details once you have identified the mismatch.

A payment is taking a long time to confirm. Confirmation is a manual review step performed by whoever manages the unit. If it has been longer than a few hours, reach out to your landlord, manager, or caretaker directly. If it still cannot be resolved between you, use the in app dispute tool to create a shared, timestamped record of the issue.

A meter reading looks wrong. RentaPay flags a reading that looks unusually high or low compared to that meter's own history before it is used to calculate a bill, so double check the reading against the physical meter before finalising. If a genuine explanation exists, such as a tenant who moved in partway through the month, you can override the calculated occupied days or amount for that specific unit before finalising.

A general manager cannot complete an action. Certain sensitive actions require the general manager's own Operations PIN, entered again at the moment of that action, separate from their login password. If they have forgotten it, they can reset it from their own settings the same way they would reset a forgotten login password.

A caretaker cannot see something a landlord can. This is expected, not a bug. A caretaker account has a deliberately narrower set of permissions than a property manager or landlord, described in the Landlord Portal section of this guide. If a caretaker genuinely needs broader access, the landlord can grant it, or add that person as a property manager instead.

RentaPay itself seems to be down. Check the public status page, available at any time without needing to log in, which shows the live state of every major part of the platform, including payments, email delivery, and file storage individually, so you can quickly tell whether the issue is on RentaPay's side or your own connection.

Still stuck? Reach RentaPay support through in app chat, the call number, WhatsApp, or email shown on your own portal's Help section, whichever is easiest for you.

A subscription payment did not go through. If you used the automatic M Pesa STK push option and did not see the prompt on your phone, check that you have enough M Pesa balance and a stable network connection, then try again from the subscription screen. If you paid manually to RentaPay's own Paybill or Till number instead, remember that a manual payment needs a RentaPay administrator to review and confirm it before access unlocks, which can take a little longer than the automatic option.

A tenant says they cannot see their unit anymore. This usually means the tenant's account was deactivated, either because a landlord or manager removed them, or because a vacating notice they submitted reached its move out date. Their payment history and portable reputation record are preserved either way, so nothing about their past tenancy is lost even though the unit itself is no longer showing.

How to reach support

RentaPay makes its support contact details visible everywhere they might be needed, including on screens a user sees before they have even logged in, so nobody is ever stuck without a way to get help.

What is shown, and where

Every portal, plus the logged out login and status screens, shows a support email address and one or more call or WhatsApp numbers. These are not hardcoded; they are configured centrally and can include several separate lines, for example a primary number and a backup number, or different lines for different times of day, all managed from one place so every screen across the whole platform always shows the same, current information.

In app chat

Beyond a phone call or a WhatsApp message, RentaPay also has its own in app chat, letting you reach RentaPay's own support team directly from within the platform, with a full history of your conversation kept so you never have to repeat yourself if a different support staff member picks it up. Once your query is resolved, you may be asked to rate the support you received, and, if that rating has not yet been given, RentaPay may send a single reminder asking for it.

Landlord to tenant messaging

Separately from RentaPay's own support chat, a landlord or manager can message a tenant directly through the same chat feature, where that option has been enabled, keeping tenant communication in one place rather than scattered across phone calls and separate messaging apps.

The public status page

If you are trying to work out whether an issue is something support needs to help with, or simply a wider, temporary problem on RentaPay's own side, check the public status page first. It requires no login, refreshes automatically, and breaks down the platform's health into the specific parts that matter, sign in, payments, email delivery, push notifications, file storage, background jobs, support chat, and the public listings page, so you can see exactly what, if anything, is affected before reaching out.

Before you reach out

A little context speeds up almost every support conversation. Have the tenant's unit and property name ready, the approximate time an issue occurred, and, where a payment is involved, the transaction code in question. This is not required to get help, but it usually means your first message already has everything support needs to look into it right away, rather than a back and forth just to gather basic details.

Staying up to date

RentaPay is used entirely through a web browser, whether that is a phone browser, a desktop browser, or an installed home screen icon, so a new feature or fix is available the moment it is deployed, without anyone needing to download or install an update.

Why you might see an update banner

If a tab is left open for a long time, or reopened from a home screen icon, it can end up still running an older version of the app even after a new version has been deployed. RentaPay checks for this automatically every few minutes while a tab is open, and, if a newer version exists, shows a small banner letting you know an update is available. Refreshing the page loads the new version immediately; there is nothing to install and no account setting to change.

Nothing is gated by when you joined

Every account, whichever role it belongs to and whenever it was created, runs the exact same version of RentaPay as every other account, all of the time. A new feature becomes available to everyone the moment it ships, not gradually, and not based on how long an account has existed.

Using RentaPay on any device

RentaPay is designed mobile first, since most tenants, and a good number of caretakers and property managers, use it primarily from a phone. It works the same way in any modern browser, on a phone, a tablet, or a desktop computer, and there is no separate app to install to get the full set of features.

Photos that respond to how you browse them

Wherever you browse a set of unit photos, whether in the unit editor as a landlord, or in the full screen viewer as a tenant or a prospective tenant on a public listing, the same smooth, focus based photo strip is used: scroll through the thumbnails and whichever photo is centered scales up and brightens, while its neighbours settle back, so browsing several photos feels natural on a touch screen without needing to tap through them one at a time.

No installation required

Because RentaPay runs entirely in the browser, there is nothing to download from an app store and nothing that needs to be kept updated manually. Simply visiting RentaPay's own web address, or opening a home screen icon if one has been added previously, is enough to get the current version of the app every time, as described in the previous section.

Frequently asked questions

What if a tenant does not pay? The unit shows as overdue in your dashboard as soon as the due date passes, so you know immediately rather than at month end reconciliation. RentaPay records and reports what has happened; how you follow up is a matter between you and your tenant, under your own tenancy agreement and applicable law.

Can I manage multiple properties from one account? Yes. There is no limit on properties or units, and you can invite different managers, caretakers, or general managers to different properties.

Does RentaPay ever hold my rent money? No. Rent is paid directly from tenant to landlord by M Pesa, whether through Paybill, Till, or Send Money. RentaPay never holds, takes custody of, or has control over that money at any point. It only records what the tenant submitted and what the landlord, manager, or caretaker confirmed. See the Terms of Service for the full explanation of what RentaPay is and is not.

Is my data secure? Only people you have explicitly invited can access your properties, and their access is scoped to what you have given them. Passwords and Operations PINs are stored as one way cryptographic hashes, never as plain text, and every request is sent over an encrypted connection. See the Privacy Policy for full detail on how data is stored and handled.

How do payments get confirmed? A tenant pays and submits their payment code in the app; the landlord, or their manager or caretaker, reviews and approves it, and everything updates automatically from there. See "How payments flow" earlier in this guide for the full picture, including how a landlord's own subscription payment can be confirmed automatically instead.

How is a security deposit handled? You record the amount a tenant paid at move in, kept completely separate from their rent balance. When the tenancy ends, you record whether it was refunded in full, partially refunded with a stated reason, or forfeited. RentaPay never holds that money either; it is purely a record of what was agreed and what happened.

What happens if I want to stop using RentaPay? See the Terms of Service for details on account suspension and termination, and the Privacy Policy for how a data deletion request works.

Where can tenants get help? Every portal, including the logged out screens, shows the support call number, WhatsApp number, and email address configured for your account, plus in app chat, so tenants always have a direct way to reach support.

Can a tenant take their payment history to a new landlord? A tenant's aggregate rating, built from every landlord who has rated them, is tied to their own email address, not to any one landlord's account, so it can follow them to a new landlord on RentaPay entirely at the tenant's own choice, or be shared through a link the tenant generates themselves.

Can a general manager revert an action they took by mistake? For a defined set of sensitive actions, yes. A landlord can review a general manager's activity log and revert certain actions within a limited window after they were taken.

What happens if a tenant cannot pay the full month at once? They can propose a payment plan directly from their portal, splitting the amount into at least two installments with their own due dates, for the landlord to approve or decline.

What happens when a tenant gives notice to vacate? Their unit is marked as notice given immediately, and RentaPay reminds them automatically as the move out date approaches. On that date, their account is deactivated and the unit becomes vacant, ready to be re listed, while their payment history and portable reputation record are preserved rather than deleted.

Can a tenant change their mind after giving notice? Yes, as long as it is before the notice date itself. They should contact their landlord, manager, or caretaker directly to have the notice revoked.

Can I bill tenants for water or electricity through RentaPay? Yes, through utility submetering. See the dedicated section of this guide for how shared and individual meters, readings, and billing work.

Glossary

Account role. The permission level an account has: landlord, property manager, general manager, caretaker, tenant, or Brand Ambassador. Every screen and every piece of data in RentaPay checks this role before showing anything.

Aggregate rating. A tenant's overall reputation score, built from every individual rating a landlord, manager, or caretaker has given them, tied to the tenant's own email address rather than to any one landlord's account.

Confirmed payment. A payment submission a landlord, manager, or caretaker has manually reviewed and accepted as genuinely received.

Daraja API. Safaricom's own interface for initiating and receiving M Pesa transactions, used by RentaPay for a landlord's automatic subscription payments.

Digest email. The optional periodic email a landlord can opt into, summarising their portfolio: occupancy, rent collected, and vacant units missing photos.

Installment. One scheduled part of a payment plan a tenant has proposed, made up of an amount and a due date.

Loyalty discount. A discount on a subscription that RentaPay may grant to a long standing, continuously active landlord account, subject to its own expiry date.

Notice given. The status a unit moves into once a tenant has submitted a vacating notice, shown clearly on the landlord's dashboard ahead of the actual move out date.

Occupied days. The number of days a unit had an active tenant during a billing period, used to fairly split the cost of a shared utility meter across several units.

Operations PIN. A general manager's own four digit code, separate from their login password, required again before certain sensitive actions can be completed.

Payment plan. An arrangement a tenant proposes to split a payment into several smaller installments, subject to the landlord's approval.

Portable reputation. A tenant's aggregate rating, tied to their own email address, that can follow them to a new landlord on RentaPay, or be shared through a link the tenant generates themselves.

Publicly listed. The state of a vacant unit once a landlord has marked it to appear on RentaPay's public vacant unit listing pages, visible to anyone browsing without an account.

Security deposit. An amount a tenant pays at the start of a tenancy, tracked completely separately from their rent balance, and settled as refunded, partially refunded, or forfeited once the tenancy ends.

Submission. Proof of a payment, whether rent, a subscription, or a utility bill, entered into RentaPay and awaiting review.

Subscription. A landlord's own ongoing payment to RentaPay for access to the platform, priced per unit per month, separate entirely from any tenant's rent.

Vacating notice. A tenant's own notification, submitted from their portal, of their intended move out date.

WhatsApp connect link. The link shown on a public listing page that opens a WhatsApp conversation with the right landlord, manager, or caretaker for that unit, without ever displaying the underlying phone number on the page itself.

Written comment. An optional note a landlord or tenant can attach to a rating, visible only to the tenant it is about, never to another landlord.